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Alienware X14

Sleek, Stylish, Powerful

The Alienware X14 is Dell's self-proclaimed "world's thinnest 14-inch gaming laptop", and at a glance, this is certainly a very compact device. Don't let that fool you though, because it comes packed with great hardware. Of course, all of this does not come cheap. Is the Alienware X14 worth the price? Read our review to find out.



BUILD AND DESIGN

The Alienware X14 is a sight to behold. The laptop's outer body is composed of magnesium alloy. The internal body makes use of aluminium and stainless steel. The vents and surfaces inside the laptop, such as the bezels and keyboard, use plastic. The X14 comes with a new, patent pending hinge system which moves back and forth along a track which results in a more stable experience while using the lid. Additionally, the lid doesn't sit completely flat when closed, and is at a slight angle to make opening the laptop easier. With such a small form factor, things are squished on the keyboard to ensure everything you need is present. However, the keys themselves are pleasant to type on, have tactile feedback, and decent travel as far as laptop keyboards are concerned. The RGB backlight is not per-key, so no custom lighting layouts. The rear section is where you will find all the laptop's IO ports. The "world's thinnest 14-inch gaming laptop" is only 1.4cm thick and at 1.8kg fairly light as well. There are two variants of the X14, the one we received has a 3050Ti, but there's a variant with an RTX 3060, more RAM, and storage capacity as well.

IO PORTS

Speaking of IO ports, you've got plenty of options. A USB 3.2 Gen 1 port, a USB 3.2 Gen 2 Type-C port, and two Thunderbolt 4 ports. You've also got an

audio combo jack, an HDMI 2.1 port and a MicroSD slot as well. An adapter is also provided along with it in the box.

DISPLAY

A 14-inch display might be on the smaller side for a lot of people. However, during our time with the laptop, we didn't at any point think that the size was hindering our enjoyment. The 1080p display is crisp, with vivid colours, which our benchmarks can attest to. It's also bright, reaching close to 400nits at peak brightness. The 144Hz refresh rate is also nice, especially for gaming.

PERFORMANCE

The X14 comes packed with the latest 12th gen Intel Core i7-12700H processor. The 14 cores and 20 threads should have no trouble meeting any and all of your multitasking needs, as can be seen on our Cinebench R20, R23 and PCMark10 benchmark results. We tested the 16GB LPDDR5 memory several times on AIDA64; however we did come across an anomaly where the L1 read and write speeds were always far too low to be right. However, the memory read and write speed speaks for itself. The X14 also has fast NVMe storage. We were getting close to 6500 MB/s read speeds and 4000 MB/s write speeds in our tests, which are

close to as advertised and fantastic. On paper, the Alienware X14 has great specs. For the most part, this reflects on 3DMark performance benchmark results as well. However, when compared to the similarly specced Lenovo IdeaPad Gaming 3i, the X14 just barely falls short in some benchmarks. The same continues with real-world gaming benchmarks as well, with the X14 at par or slightly behind the 3i. This may well have to do with its compact nature.

NOISE AND HEAT

The X14 has two fans, each independently controlled to cool the CPU and GPU.

While this keeps the temps somewhat in check, you could be forgiven for thinking the X14 was about to take off from a runway. It does actually get that loud. But the tradeoff is worth it in our opinion, better to be loud than hot. At least in the case of a gaming laptop.



FEATURES & SPECS.....81
PERFORMANCE.....83
VALUE FOR MONEY...57
DESIGN.....89

VERDICT

All things said and done, the Alienware X14 is an impressive machine. It's compact, looks extremely stylish, and comes with some crazy specs. However, it could have done more in the specs department for the price, since you can get similar and in some cases even better gaming performance on cheaper laptops, such as the Lenovo Gaming 3i we compared the X14 against in this review. That being said, we totally wouldn't fault you for going for this just for its looks if you have the moolah for it.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 1920 x 1080, 144Hz | PROCESSOR: 12th Gen Intel Core i7-12700H | GRAPHICS: Nvidia RTX 3050 Ti | MEMORY: 16GB LPDDR5, 5200 MHz | OS: Windows 11 Home | STORAGE: 512GB NVMe SSD | PORTS: 1x USB 3.2 Gen 1 port, 1x USB 3.2 Gen 2 Type-C with PD and DisplayPort, 2x Thunderbolt 4 port with PD and DisplayPort, 1x headset combo port, 1x HDMI 2.1 port, 1x MicroSD Port | CONNECTIVITY: Intel AX211, Wi-Fi 6E, Bluetooth 5.2 | BATTERY: 80 Whr | DIMENSIONS: 321.5mm x 262.77mm x 14.5mm (WxDxH) | WEIGHT: 1.8kg

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